

4.5

Making suggestions

A Underline the phrases used for making suggestions in examples 1–4 below.

- 1 Shall we postpone the launch of the new product until the spring?
- 2 Can I make a suggestion? Why don't we try a poster campaign on bus stops?
- 3 It's just an idea, but what about using an outside company to recruit and select our senior managers?
- 4 Let's go back for a moment, if that's OK. Perhaps we should rethink the whole project?

Match the beginnings and endings below to make replies used for *accepting* a suggestion.

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| 5 OK, let's ... | ... worth trying. |
| 6 Yes, I think that would ... | ... do that. |
| 7 Yes, that might be ... | ... what you mean. |
| 8 Right. I can see ... | ... work really well. |

Now do the same for these replies used for *rejecting* a suggestion.

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| 9 I can see one or two ... | ... about that, to be honest. |
| 10 That sounds like a good idea, but I ... | ... think so? |
| 11 I'm not really sure ... | ... don't think it would work. |
| 12 Do you ... | ... problems with that idea. |

B Work with a partner. Student A read out each suggestion 1–4 above. Student B cover the second half of the replies 5–12 with a piece of paper and reply by accepting or rejecting. Change roles and repeat when you finish.

C The rejecting phrases above are all quite diplomatic. Below is a stronger phrase. Add one more.

I'm sorry, I don't think that's a good idea. _____

D Work with a new partner. Student A make suggestions (invent your own ideas). Student B reply by accepting or rejecting. If you reject the suggestion, add a reason.

E Work in small groups. Choose one of the problems below. Make suggestions and decide on the best solution. At the end tell the class what you decided.

- 1 You live in a country with a lot of rainforest. Your company is a timber company (you cut down trees and export the wood). You contribute to the development of your country by providing jobs and paying taxes. Environmental groups are trying to restrict your activities.
- 2 You work for a Sunday newspaper which is second in the market. Your newspaper is a good product, but the market leader has just cut their price and started a very aggressive advertising campaign. You need to think of a loyalty scheme to keep your readers.
- 3 One of your main customers has not paid their last three invoices. They now owe you \$100,000. You have already sent a polite letter asking them to pay as soon as possible. They are a large company and you don't want to lose their business.
- 4 One of you (decide who) has just inherited \$20,000 from a rich aunt. Suggest how to invest the money for long-term growth.

